

AMENDMENT OF SOLICITATION			1. CONTRACT ID CODE		PAGE OF PAGES 1 3		
2. AMENDMENT/MODIFICATION NO. 0001		3. EFFECTIVE DATE August 17th, 2026		4. REQUISITION/PURCHASE REQ. NO. PR16160525		5. PROJECT NO. (If applicable)	
6. ISSUED BY U.S. Embassy Canberra GSO Procurement Office 21 Moonah Place Yarralumla ACT 2600 Australia			CODE		7. ADMINISTERED BY (If other than Item 6) CODE		
8. NAME AND ADDRESS OF CONTRACTOR (NO., street, city, county, State, and ZIP Code)				9a. AMENDMENT OF SOLICITATION NO. 19AS2026Q0031			
				9b. DATED (SEE ITEM 11) August 17th, 2026			
				10a. MODIFICATION OF CONTRACT/ORDER NO.			
				10b. DATED (SEE ITEM 13)			
11. THIS ITEM ONLY APPLIES TO AMENDMENTS OF SOLICITATIONS							
[X] The above numbered solicitation is amended as set forth in Item 14. The hour and date specified for receipt of Offers. [] is extended, [X] is not extended. Offers must acknowledge receipt of this amendment prior to the hour and date specified in the solicitation or as amended, by one of the following methods: (a) By completing Items 8 and 15, and returning <u>1</u> copies of the amendment; (b) By acknowledging receipt of this amendment on each copy of the offer submitted; or (c) By separate letter or telegram which includes a reference to the solicitation and amendment numbers. FAILURE OF YOUR ACKNOWLEDGMENT TO BE RECEIVED AT THE PLACE DESIGNATED FOR THE RECEIPT OF OFFERS PRIOR TO THE HOUR AND DATE SPECIFIED MAY RESULT IN REJECTION OF YOUR OFFER. If by virtue of this amendment you desire to change an offer already submitted, such change may be made by telegram or letter, provided each telegram or letter makes reference to the solicitation and this amendment and is received prior to the opening hour and date specified.							
12. ACCOUNTING AND APPROPRIATION DATA (If required)							
13. THIS ITEM APPLIES ONLY TO MODIFICATIONS OF CONTRACTS/ORDERS, IT MODIFIES THE CONTRACT/ORDER NO. AS DESCRIBED IN ITEM 14.							
A. THIS CHANGE ORDER IS ISSUED PURSUANT TO: (Specify authority) THE CHANGES SET FORTH IN ITEM 14 ARE MADE IN THE CONTRACT ORDER NO. IN ITEM 10A.							
B. THE ABOVE NUMBERED CONTRACT/ORDER IS MODIFIED TO REFLECT THE ADMINISTRATIVE CHANGES (such as changes in paying office, appropriation date, etc.) SET FORTH IN ITEM 14, PURSUANT TO THE AUTHORITY OF FAR 43.103(b)							
C. THIS SUPPLEMENTAL AGREEMENT IS ENTERED INTO PURSUANT TO AUTHORITY OF:							
D. OTHER (Specify type of modification and authority)							
E. IMPORTANT: Contractor [] is not, [] is required to sign this document and return ____ copies to the issuing office.							
14. DESCRIPTION OF AMEND This amendment is issued to: Amendment to provide Questions & Answers received for solicitation number 19AS2026Q0031; and Amend Section 3 – Solicitation Provisions, paragraph A.2.8.All other terms and conditions of the solicitation remain unchanged.							
15A. NAME AND TITLE OF SIGNER (Type or print)				16A. NAME OF CONTRACTING OFFICER Paul Rau			
15B. NAME OF CONTRACTOR/OFFEROR BY _____ (Signature of person authorized to sign)		15C. DATE SIGNED		16B. UNITED STATES OF AMERICA BY _____ (Signature of Contracting Officer)		16C. DATE SIGNED	

Amend Section 3 – Solicitation Provisions, paragraph A.2.8.

Original wording:

“Evidence that the offeror/quoter can provide the necessary personnel and financial resources needed to perform the work, including qualified subject-matter experts in semiconductor supply chains, defense/national security policy, and strategic communications.”

Revised wording:

“Evidence that the offeror/quoter can provide the necessary personnel and financial resources needed to perform the work, including qualified subject-matter experts and strategic communications.”

Questions and Answers

Q1. Conference Scheduling: The solicitation states that conference dates will be determined between the contractor and the Embassy no later than August 31, 2027. Could you please advise whether the Embassy has preferred months or a preferred sequencing for the three conferences across Canberra, Sydney, and Melbourne within the contract period?

Answer: There are no required dates or sequencing for the conferences. The service provider should propose (approximate) dates that it determines to be ideal for reaching an appropriate target number of Australians to enroll in the program, factoring in local and U.S. holidays, school breaks, Parliamentary/government schedules and other considerations that could hinder successful participant recruitment.

Q2. Delivery Format: Could you please confirm whether all three conferences are intended to be delivered in person only, or whether a hybrid or virtual delivery format would be acceptable for any of the conferences?

Answer: The conferences should be delivered in-person with a lead moderator present to engage with the participants. If the service provider intends to create a conference agenda with multiple experts contributing, the U.S. Embassy has no objection to some (but not all) experts participating remotely to ensure availability of qualified subject matter experts.

Q3. Participant Identification: The solicitation specifies that Australian government officials will be selected in coordination with the U.S. Embassy and relevant consulates. Could you please clarify the Embassy's role in identifying and inviting participants, and whether the contractor is expected to independently develop a participant outreach strategy?

Answer: The contractor should identify a strategy to identify participants who are new to Australian and subnational government positions who would benefit from instruction in the U.S. policy process, the American-Australian Alliance, and American institutions. The U.S. Embassy can facilitate invitations to the participants into the program; access to U.S. facilities if required; and provide additional invitees to the contractor for consideration in enrollment. The contractor is responsible for building the roster of participants.

Q4. Audience Scope: The solicitation references the closing reception as bringing together business leaders, academics, and policy experts in addition to government participants. Could you please confirm whether the primary conference audience is limited to Australian government officials, or whether private sector, industry, and academic participants are also included in the main conference program?

Answer: The contractor will propose an end-of-conference reception that may include U.S. officials and external guests at the discretion of the U.S. Embassy – which will make a determination based on security and safety factors, such as event site capacity limitations. The primary conference audiences should primarily focus on Australian and subnational officials, but the contractor may propose a strategy that showcases how the U.S. Government would benefit from a broader audience profile that could include additional sector employees whose work in international affairs would be strengthened through a better understanding of the United States, its policies and alliances.

Q5. Subject-Matter Experts: The solicitation requires qualified subject-matter experts in semiconductor supply chains, defence and national security policy, and strategic communications. Could you please advise whether the Embassy has preferred speakers or an existing roster of approved subject-matter experts, or whether the contractor is expected to independently identify and propose all speakers?

Answer: The Embassy does not have a preferred speaker, but requests the contractor to provide justification for its proposed slate of subject matter experts. The lead coordinator for the contractor should be an expert in the United States, its foreign policies and the American-Australian alliance. There is no requirement for the contractor to furnish all subject matter experts from its own internal roster; a think tank, for example, can invite experts from other institutions to complement its own staff's lead instruction.

Q6. Strategic Messaging Campaign: The solicitation references a strategic messaging campaign to share the findings of the final report. Could you please provide additional detail on the scope, channels, and audience for this campaign?

Answer: The contractor will develop a strategic messaging campaign that may draw on social media, blog posts, op-ed submissions, or media interviews to highlight the successes of the conference series as a way to improve alignment between the U.S. and Australia through instruction on the United States.

Q7 . For this project and the below statement does the embassy require a formal office, or will a staff person on the ground suffice? "The offeror shall provide evidence that it operates an established business with a permanent address within Australia or provide a plan to establish a presence within thirty (30) days of contract award. This local presence must be maintained for the full duration of the contract and shall be capable of supporting day-to-day contract coordination, reporting, and liaison with U.S. Embassy/Consulate staff.

A staff member located in Australia may satisfy this requirement, provided the offeror has a registered business address in Australia and complies with the solicitation requirement that:

"This local presence must be maintained for the full duration of the contract and shall be capable of supporting day-to-day contract coordination, reporting, and liaison with U.S. Embassy/Consulate staff."

Q8. Can the US Embassy, if awarded, provide GST exemption letters for U.S. offerors?

No